



Teens sue Musk's xAI over altered photos

Plaintiffs in lawsuit claim Grok chatbox created sexual images of them

BY FAIZ SIDDIQUI

When a mother from eastern Tennessee asked local police how someone had created naked photos of her teenage daughter, she recalls being told it was a company she'd never heard of: xAI, the artificial intelligence start-up run by Tesla CEO Elon Musk.

Police alleged a person arrested in December had used Grok, xAI's chatbot, to edit photos, including one from the teen girl's Instagram account, removing a blue bikini from one image to "depict her without any clothes," according to a lawsuit filed Monday.

The teen is suing xAI as part of a group of Tennessee teenagers who allege the company's AI tools were used to create nude images of them by editing photos in which they were clothed. The edited photos spread across Discord and Telegram in recent months, and some were bartered for other child sexual abuse material in online chatrooms, according to the complaint, which was first reported by The Washington Post.

The lawsuit, filed in the Northern District of California on Monday, alleges a single perpetrator compiled images and videos of more than 18 girls, many of whom attended the same school, and digitally altered some of them using AI. It is the first action brought by alleged minor victims of child sexual abuse material stemming from an "undressing" scandal that has plagued xAI in recent months.

SEE GROK ON A14



AFP/GETTY IMAGES

An aircraft prepares for landing as a smoke plume from an Iranian airstrike rises from a fire near Dubai International Airport on Monday.

Trump-Xi summit delayed over issue of Hormuz

President pushes China to help reopen the vital oil route blocked by Iran

BY CATE CADELL

President Donald Trump has delayed a trip to China this month as he pressures Beijing and NATO allies to send warships to help the United States reopen the Strait of Hormuz, throwing into question a long-planned effort to reset relations between the world's two

largest economies.

The U.S. campaign in Iran, now in its third week, has unsettled global energy markets and injected a note of uncertainty into Washington's broader foreign policy agenda, as Trump called on allies and rivals alike to help reopen the strait — a vital artery for global oil and gas supplies — in an apparent acknowledgment that the task cannot be managed by the U.S. military alone.

Speaking from the Oval Office on Monday, Trump said he had sent a request to China that the summit be delayed by "a month or so," citing the war.

"I'm looking forward to being with them. We have a very good relationship ... but because of the war, I want to be here," he said. He added that China "should be thanking" the United States for its efforts in Iran and said he was surprised it was not "eager" to help.

One Chinese official familiar with the preparations earlier told The Washington Post that a delay was likely and that a new date had not been set. The official spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitive diplomacy surrounding the summit.

Beijing — unlike the White

House — had not publicly confirmed the March 31-April 2 visit, a common practice in Chinese diplomatic planning given the potential for last-minute changes.

Trump told reporters aboard Air Force One on Sunday that he was urging about seven countries to send warships to escort vessels through the strait.

At the time, Trump did not clarify which countries he had requested support from, but he said in a Truth Social post on Saturday that he hoped "China, France, Japan, South Korea, the UK, and others" would send ships to the region.

SEE CHINA ON A11

Report: Iran's regime intact

GROUP IS WEAKENED BUT MORE HARD-LINE

Western officials see little hope for changing leaders

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA, WARREN P. STROBEL AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

Despite more than two weeks of relentless airstrikes, U.S. intelligence assessments say, Iran's regime likely will remain in place for now, weakened but more hard-line, with the powerful Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps security forces exerting greater control.

The United States and Israel have significantly degraded Iran's missile capability and navy, removed the supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, and wiped out scores of top military and intelligence leaders. But the war's costs are mounting — at least \$12 billion so far and 13 U.S. troops killed. Iran's viselike grip on the Strait of Hormuz has slowed shipping traffic to a trickle, creating a historic oil disruption.

Western officials and analysts who study Iran said they see little near-term prospect of a "regime change" end to the 47-year-old

SEE IRAN ON A10

Wiles has cancer: Key adviser to president will continue to work. **A3**

Commerce targeted: An Iranian drone strikes Dubai's airport. **A9**

Injuries update: More than 200 U.S. troops have been wounded. **A9**

He said he didn't do it to the end. Will a DNA test finally clear him?

BY JOANNA SLATER

Over his 34 years in prison, Shawn Tanner always maintained he was not guilty of murder, insisting on his innocence right up until his death in 2022.

Now a years-long legal battle will grant his final wish: for DNA testing to be conducted on crucial evidence in his case.

The prosecutor's office that obtained his conviction fought the testing, arguing that his death invalidated his request and that the results wouldn't prove his innocence anyway.

His advocates disagreed, arguing that the results could not only

lead to his exoneration but also offer a clue in the unsolved case of an infamous serial killer.

The result: A debate over whether the dead can clear their names that eventually reached the Massachusetts Supreme Judicial Court, testing legal boundaries and fundamental notions of justice along the way.

Every state now has a legal avenue where people can request DNA testing of evidence after being convicted. But in many cases, it's not clear if those statutes apply once convicts have died, said Brandon Garrett, a law professor at Duke University.

SEE DNA ON A7

Plan to close Kennedy Center receives approval

BY JANAY KINGSBERRY AND TRAVIS M. ANDREWS

The John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts will move forward with President Donald Trump's plans to shutter the institution for two years after its board of trustees voted Monday to approve the proposal — clearing the way for sweeping renovations at the nation's premier performing arts center.

Trustees' vote clears path for Trump's massive two-year renovation

Meeting at the White House on Monday, the Kennedy Center's general trustees, who were handpicked by Trump after his takeover of the institution last

year, unanimously voted to close the complex this summer for a two-year renovation project.

They also voted to install Matt Floca, who previously ran facilities operations, at the helm of the Kennedy Center, following the departure of Richard Grenell last week.

Before the board proceedings, Trump hosted a news conference touting what he called "incredible strides" under his leadership

to restore the center's "true purpose and prestige" and welcoming Floca, who he said would oversee the building's construction crew and planning.

"Matt, I'm here to a certain extent to wish you good luck on everything," Trump said, not 15 minutes after saying he would fire Floca if he doesn't perform well.

Trump said the Kennedy Center had been "literally on the

SEE KENNEDY CENTER ON A2

Federal judge's ruling blocks RFK Jr.'s vaccines overhaul

BY LENA H. SUN AND RACHEL ROUBEIN

A federal judge on Monday blocked the Trump administration from implementing sweeping changes to the nation's childhood immunization schedule, siding with major medical organizations that argue Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. unlawfully altered vaccine policy and improperly reconstituted a federal vaccine advisory panel.

Under Kennedy, the federal government has cut the number of shots routinely recommended

to children, including for flu, hepatitis A, rotavirus and meningococcal disease. Kennedy also dismissed all 17 members of the vaccine advisory panel to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention last year, installing new members, several of whom have criticized vaccines, especially covid-19 mRNA shots.

Several groups sued, including the American Academy of Pediatrics, the American College of Physicians and the Infectious Diseases Society of America.

In his 45-page opinion, Judge

SEE RFK ON A2



PETER W. STEVENSON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Seeking shelter

People walk in the rain Monday in Washington, where the weather turned out to be not as extreme as it was across other parts of the U.S. **Story, A3**

IN THE NEWS

DHS silent As America's conflict with Iran continues, agency has not given the public its assessment of dangers facing the U.S. **A4**

Virginia's redistricting plan has become a key to Democrats' hopes of perhaps winning control of the House in November, but by no means is it an automatic victory. **B11**

THE NATION **The president** revealed that retiring Rep. Neal Dunn (R-Florida) is fighting a terminal illness and said that doctors previously told Dunn he could be "dead by June. **A3**

THE WORLD **Deportees sent** by the Trump administration to a notorious Salvadoran megaprison are still stuck a year later, and little is known about the status or whereabouts of those prisoners. **A8**

THE ECONOMY **A Trump law** that went into effect on Monday will cause some 200,000 immigrant truck drivers to lose their commercial licenses. **A12** **New research** shows which jobs are most vulnerable to being replaced by artificial intelligence. **A13**

STYLE **The Oscars** were handed out Sunday night, and these were the best moments from Hollywood's biggest, brightest night of the year. **B1** **SPORTS** **The WBC** semifinal matching the U.S. and the Dominicans delivered on the hype. **B7**

THE REGION **New sonar** images captured by an underwater robot provide the best ever look of the USS Monitor, a famous Civil War vessel wreck. **B11** **A Jan. 6 rioter** who was pardoned is barred from riding Metro after being accused of touching a women's hair. **B11**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A12
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B13
OPINION PAGES.....A15
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A8

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54523

